RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

23 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 5:51 PM, Friday 23 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 74 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Halted** · 38 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 17,070 minutes at 6:00 PM; no takeoffs or landings since 3:00 PM, last movement the permitted Saudia SV979 from Guangzhou at 10:26 AM. Dammam airport halted since 4:41 PM, 79 minutes, with no takeoff or landing since Saudia SV1118 landed from Jeddah; no cause announced

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 17,070 minutes at 6:00 PM; NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight**.
- No Riyadh takeoffs or landings since 3:00 PM; 74 Riyadh flights cancelled so far on Friday (44%).
- Coalition intercepted a Houthi ballistic missile fired toward Khamis Mushait at 3:03 PM; no damage or casualties stated.
- Dammam airport halted since 4:41 PM, 79 minutes, no cause announced; 5 takeoffs and 2 landings since 3:00 PM, last Saudia SV1118 from Jeddah 4:41 PM.
- Saudi FM in Istanbul for R4 talks with Pakistan, Turkey and Egypt, then European states, on Yemen and Red Sea and Hormuz shipping.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (17062 min).

74	0/0	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

HALTED

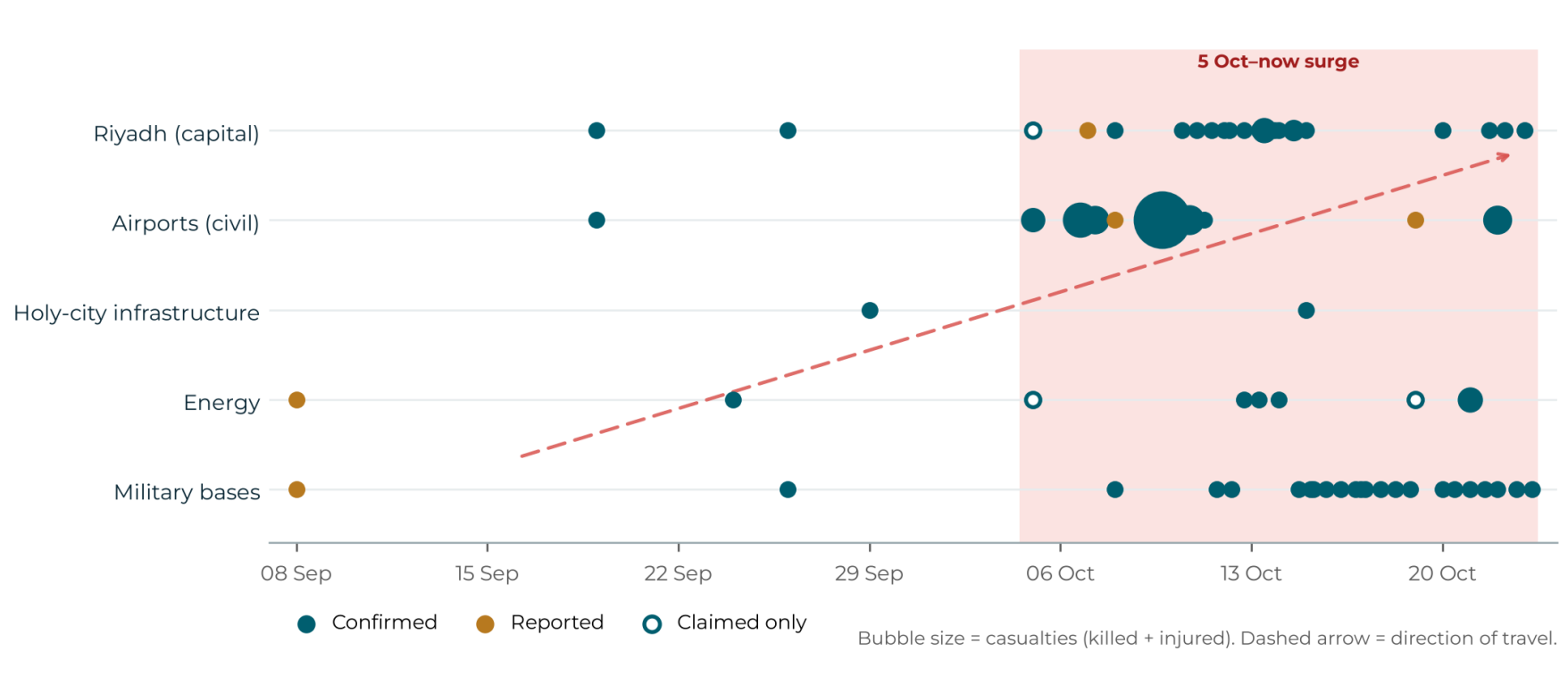
No takeoff or landing since 4:41 PM (70 min).

38	0/0	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (17,070 min at 6:00 PM); 0 takeoffs and 0 landings since 3:00 PM
- Dammam halted since 4:41 PM (79 min at 6:00 PM, no cause announced); 5 takeoffs and 2 landings since 3:00 PM, latest Saudia SV1115 to Jeddah 4:32 PM and Saudia SV1118 from Jeddah 4:41 PM
- Coalition intercepted a Houthi ballistic missile fired toward Khamis Mushait (SPA, 3:03 PM); no damage or casualties stated
- Saudi FM joined R4 talks in Istanbul, then a session with European states; state TV aired more Riyadh and Dammam attack survivor accounts

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 23 OCT



65 sourced events since 8 September (57 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: a ballistic missile launched by the Houthis toward Khamis Mushait was intercepted and destroyed; no damage or casualties stated (23 Oct, SPA). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 3:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED INTERCEPTION **3:03 PM AST · Khamis Mushait**

A ballistic missile launched by the Houthis toward Khamis Mushait was intercepted and destroyed; no damage or casualties stated. SPA

CONFIRMED CASUALTIES **3:50 PM AST · Riyadh**

French resident injured in the Riyadh airport attack lost both feet. Al Ekhbariya

CONFIRMED CASUALTIES **4:07 PM AST · Dammam**

Eastern Province health: Saudi German Hospital treated one of the injured from the Dammam airport attack. Al Ekhbariya

Last 24 hours: Attacks 1, interceptions 4, alerts 3, all-clears 3, casualty reports 3.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

3 Riyadh airport still halted; Dammam quiet since 4:41 PM; missile toward Khamis Mushait intercepted at 3:03 PM

Checked at 5:55 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: ballistic missile launched by the Houthis toward Khamis Mushait intercepted and destroyed**

SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **3:07 PM** · SPA Arabic 3:03 PM, English 3:07 PM AST Fri 23 Oct; checked 5:55 PM

SPA, quoting the coalition, said a ballistic missile fired by the Houthis toward Khamis Mushait was intercepted and destroyed. No damage or casualties were stated.

CONFIRMED DMM **Eastern Province health: Saudi German Hospital treated one of the injured from the Dammam airport attack**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **4:07 PM** · published 4:07 PM AST Fri 23 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 5:55 PM

Al Ekhbariya, citing Eastern Province health affairs, said the Saudi German Hospital received and cared for one of the people injured in the attack on Dammam airport (translated from Arabic). No new casualty totals were given.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: French resident injured in the Riyadh airport attack lost both feet**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **3:50 PM** · published 3:50 PM AST Fri 23 Oct (Arabic, translated); other survivor testimonies 3:30-3:44 PM; checked 5:55 PM

The state channel said French resident Chloe Catherine survived the Houthi attack on King Khalid International Airport but lost her feet; she said doctors are giving her excellent care (translated from Arabic). It aired several other survivor accounts; no new casualty figures.

CONFIRMED **Saudi FM takes part in the R4 ministerial meeting in Istanbul, then a second session with European states**

SPA (@Spa_Eng) and Al Ekhbariya · **5:00 PM** · SPA and Al Ekhbariya posts 3:00-5:30 PM AST Fri 23 Oct; checked 5:55 PM

SPA said Prince Faisal bin Farhan took part in the R4 meeting of Saudi Arabia, Pakistan, Turkey and Egypt in Istanbul, and Al Ekhbariya said the group's second meeting with European states began to discuss Yemen and the US-Iran war (translated from Arabic). No outcome statement yet.

CONFIRMED **European Parliament calls for the Houthis to be listed as a terrorist organisation and expresses solidarity with the Kingdom**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **11:35 AM** · published 11:35 AM AST Fri 23 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 11:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported that the European Parliament called for the Houthi group to be added to the list of terrorist organisations and for its funding channels to be dismantled, affirming its solidarity with Saudi Arabia and its support for Yemen's legitimate government (translated from Arabic).

CONFIRMED **IndiGo keeps Riyadh flights cancelled until 31 October and Dammam, Jeddah and Madinah until 27 October**

Indian Embassy in Riyadh, via PTI · **12:04 PM** · PTI story posted 12:04 PM AST Fri 23 Oct; also Business Standard, Hindustan Times; checked 2:50 PM

The Indian Embassy in Riyadh said IndiGo flights to and from Riyadh stay cancelled until 31 October inclusive, and to and from Jeddah, Dammam and Madinah until 27 October inclusive. PTI added that Air India and Air India Express have suspended Saudi flights until 24 October and Akasa Air until 27 October.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya airs footage of survivors from the Riyadh airport attack**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **1:13 PM** · published 1:13 PM AST Fri 23 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 2:50 PM

The state channel posted a short film meeting people injured in the attack on King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, now being treated at King Abdulaziz Medical City (translated from Arabic). It gives no new casualty figures.

CONFIRMED DMM **Arab League condemns the Houthi attacks on Dammam's King Fahd airport and the Shaybah oilfield**

SPA (@Spa_Eng) and Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **1:26 PM** · Al Ekhbariya 10:01 AM and 11:15 AM; SPA Arabic 12:54 PM and SPA English 1:26 PM AST Fri 23 Oct; checked 2:50 PM

The Arab League condemned the Houthi attacks on King Fahd International Airport and the Shaybah field as a violation of the Kingdom's sovereignty and a threat to its security and stability, and backed the measures Saudi Arabia takes to protect itself (translated from Arabic).

UNVERIFIED **Social account shares footage it says shows a Houthi missile impact in Riyadh overnight**

OSINT News (@OSINTNewsgrb) on X · **11:34 AM** · posted 11:34 AM AST Fri 23 Oct, quoting its own 3:25 AM post; not confirmed; checked 11:50 AM

An unverified social account posted video it says shows a direct missile impact in Riyadh from the overnight attack. The coalition said the 3:57 AM ballistic missile toward Riyadh was intercepted and destroyed, and no Saudi authority has reported an impact, damage or casualties.

CONFIRMED **Weather centre: thunderstorms, hail and fog forecast for the Eastern Province and other regions**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **7:00 AM** · published 7:00 AM AST Fri 23 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 8:48 AM

The National Center for Meteorology, via SPA, forecasts moderate to heavy thunderstorms with flash floods, hail and strong winds over Jazan, Asir, Al-Baha, Makkah, Madinah, Hail, Tabuk, Al-Jouf, the Eastern Province and the Northern Borders, with fog also forming over the Eastern Province. Fog could affect Dammam operations.

CONFIRMED **Canada tells citizens to avoid all travel to Riyadh's and Dammam's main airports**

Government of Canada travel advice · **8:48 AM** · advisory last updated 18 Oct (avoid non-essential travel to Saudi Arabia); checked 8:48 AM Fri 23 Oct

Canada's official advice says to avoid all travel to King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh and King Fahd International Airport in Dammam because ongoing military activity is disrupting operations. Al Mashhad reported at 8:07 AM that Italy also warned against travel to Saudi Arabia; the Italian text was not checked directly.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport again tells a traveller to follow official authorities for airspace updates and check with their airline**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **5:23 AM** · published 5:23 AM AST Fri 23 Oct (reply to a traveller); checked 5:52 AM

Replying to a traveller, the airport said that for the latest airspace updates people should follow the relevant official authorities and contact the airline they booked with (translated from Arabic). No reopening was announced.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense: early warning for Khamis Mushait and Abha at 5:06 AM, all-clear at 5:09 AM**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv), quoting Civil Defense · **5:06 AM** · published 5:06 and 5:09 AM AST Fri 23 Oct; checked 5:52 AM

Civil Defense issued an early-warning alert for Khamis Mushait and Abha at 5:06 AM and declared the danger over at 5:09 AM. No interception, debris or casualties were reported (translated from Arabic).

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense: early warning for the Najran region at 4:22 AM, all-clear at 4:25 AM**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv), quoting Civil Defense · **4:22 AM** · published 4:22 and 4:25 AM AST Fri 23 Oct; checked 5:52 AM

Civil Defense issued an early-warning alert for the Najran region at 4:22 AM and declared the danger over at 4:25 AM; it again warned that filming or sharing interceptions or impact sites is a legal offence. No damage reported (translated from Arabic).

CONFIRMED **Coalition: ballistic missile launched by the Houthis toward Riyadh intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA (@Spa_Eng); Reuters · **3:57 AM** · published 3:57 AM AST Fri 23 Oct (SPA English 4:03 AM; Al Ekhbariya repeated it at 5:02 AM); checked 5:52 AM

Coalition spokesman Turki Al-Maliki said air defenses intercepted and destroyed a ballistic missile the Houthis launched toward Riyadh. It followed the 3:12 AM Riyadh early warning. No damage or casualties were stated; Reuters carried the statement.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense: early warning for Riyadh at 3:12 AM, all-clear at 3:21 AM**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) / Al Ekhbariya · **3:12 AM** · published 3:12 AM (alert, Al Ekhbariya) and 3:21 AM (all-clear, @SaudiDCD) AST Fri 23 Oct; checked 5:52 AM

Civil Defense issued an early-warning alert for Riyadh at 3:12 AM. At 3:21 AM it said the danger had passed in Riyadh City and told residents to keep following instructions and avoid gathering or filming.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells travellers to follow official authorities for airspace updates and check with their airline**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **2:47 AM** · published 2:47 AM AST Fri 23 Oct (reply to a traveller); checked 2:58 AM

Replying to a traveller, the airport said that for the latest airspace updates people should follow the relevant official authorities and contact the airline they booked with (translated from Arabic). No reopening was announced.

CONFIRMED **UN says the Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia are unacceptable**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **2:12 AM** · published 2:12 AM AST Fri 23 Oct; checked 2:58 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported the United Nations as saying the Houthi attacks on the Kingdom are unacceptable (translated from Arabic).

CONFIRMED **Coalition: two Houthi drones launched toward the Southern Region intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **12:57 AM** · published 12:57 AM AST Fri 23 Oct (SPA English 1:10 AM); checked 2:58 AM

The coalition said it intercepted and destroyed two drones launched by the Houthis toward the Southern Region. No targets, damage or casualties were stated.

CONFIRMED **Coalition denies Houthi claims that the Kingdom threatened to target tribal and civilian gatherings in Yemen**

SPA (@SPAregions) / Al Ekhbariya · **11:20 PM** · published 11:20–11:39 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 11:58 PM

The coalition spokesman said Houthi claims that Saudi Arabia threatened to strike tribal and civilian gatherings are false and baseless, and called them an attempt to mislead public opinion and drag Yemeni tribes into the conflict (SPA, translated from Arabic).

CONFIRMED **Coalition: ballistic missile fired by the Houthis toward Najran intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA · **9:29 PM** · published 9:29 PM AST Thu 22 Oct (SPA English 9:41 PM); checked 11:58 PM

The coalition said it intercepted and destroyed a ballistic missile launched by the Houthis toward Najran. No damage or casualties were stated.

CONFIRMED DMM **Father of Sultan Al-Qahtani, killed in the Dammam airport attack, says his son ran to put out the fire near the aircraft**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **9:33 PM** · published 9:33 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 11:58 PM

Al Ekhbariya interviewed the father of Sultan Al-Qahtani, one of those killed in the Houthi attack on King Fahd International Airport. He said Sultan and colleagues went out after the blast and tried to put out the fire, fearing it would reach the aircraft and passengers (translated from Arabic).

CLAIM **Houthi spokesman Yahya Saree claims four drone and missile operations on Saudi Arabia in 48 hours, including the Defense Ministry in Riyadh and Dammam airport**

Houthi statement, as relayed on X · **9:58 PM** · relayed 9:47–9:58 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; not confirmed by Saudi authorities; checked 11:58 PM

Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree claimed four operations over the past 48 hours, naming the Defense Ministry headquarters in Riyadh, King Fahd International Airport in Dammam and Aramco facilities. Saudi authorities have not confirmed a strike on the Defense Ministry.

CONFIRMED DMM **Kuwait condemns the Houthi attack on Dammam's King Fahd airport**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **8:42 PM** · published 8:42 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:46 PM

Kuwait condemned what it called the flagrant attack by the Houthi militia on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam (SPA, translated from Arabic).

CONFIRMED **GCC Secretary-General condemns the Houthi attacks on Dammam airport and the Shaybah oilfield**

SPA (@Spa_Eng / @SPAregions) · **8:39 PM** · published 8:39 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:46 PM

The GCC Secretary-General condemned the two terrorist attacks by the Houthi militia that targeted King Fahd International Airport in Dammam and the Shaybah oilfield (SPA, 8:13 PM Arabic and 8:39 PM English).

CONFIRMED **European Parliament affirms solidarity with Saudi Arabia and condemns the Houthi attacks**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **8:28 PM** · published 8:28 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:46 PM

SPA reports the European Parliament affirmed its solidarity with the Kingdom and condemned the Houthi attacks (translated from Arabic).

CLAIM **Yemeni government forces say 780 strikes on Houthi positions in 24 hours, about 512 fighters neutralised**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **8:21 PM** · published 8:21 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:46 PM

Al Ekhbariya relays the Yemeni armed forces' claim that, under operation "Dawn of Yemen", 780 operations in the past 24 hours hit Houthi field commanders, positions and supply lines, neutralising about 512 fighters. Not independently verified.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (17062 min).

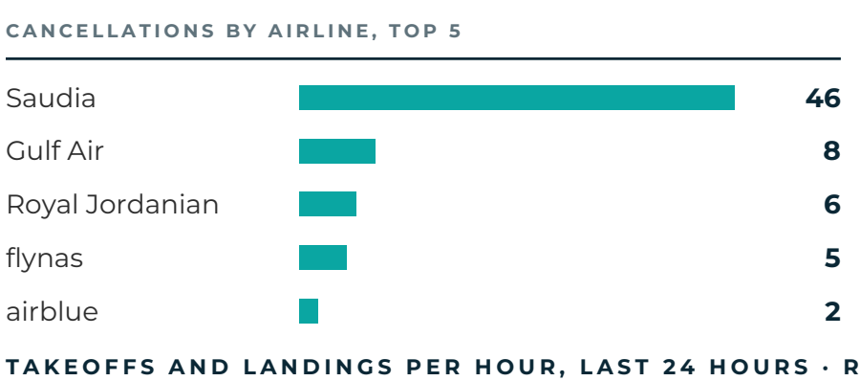
74	8:35 AM	10:26 AM	0	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
33 departures + 41 arrivals, 44% of 167 scheduled.	N437GA to Jerez (non-airline flight), 557 min before 5:51 PM.	SV979 from Guangzhou, 446 min before 5:51 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:51 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 74 at 5:52 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

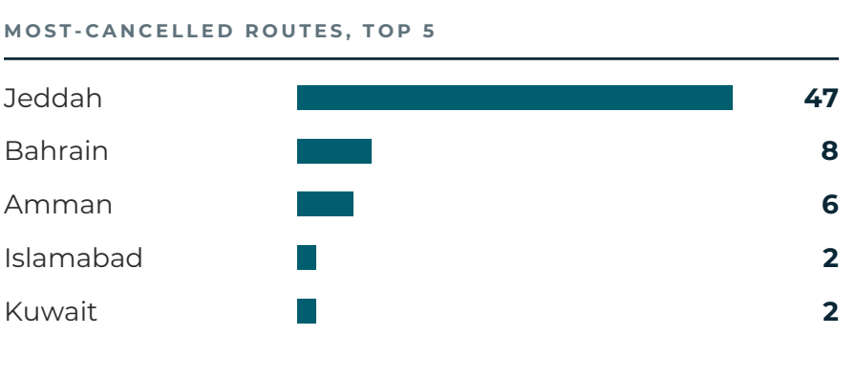
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	33	41	74	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	33 (42%)	41 (45%)	74	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	3 (4%)	3 (3%)	6	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	2 (40%)	2 (40%)	4	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	1 of 58	1 of 72	2 of 130	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	10	12	22	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	91	104	195	FR24 stats panel

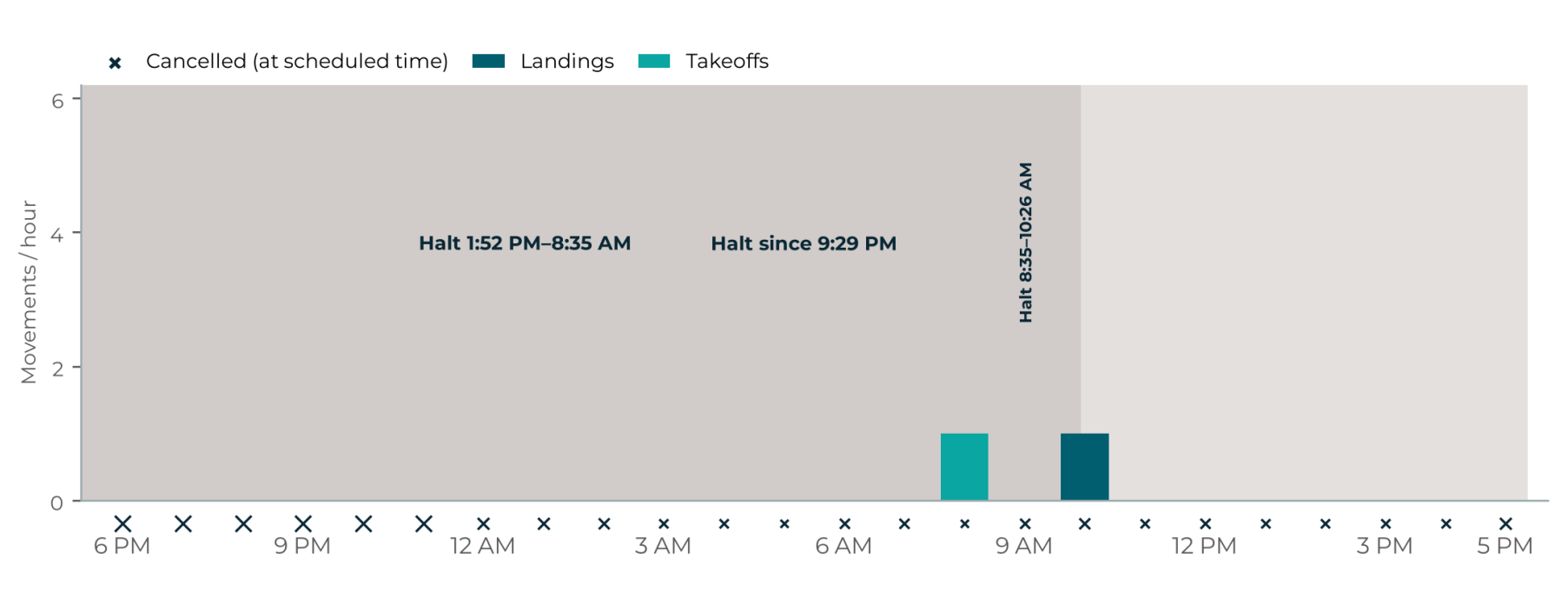
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



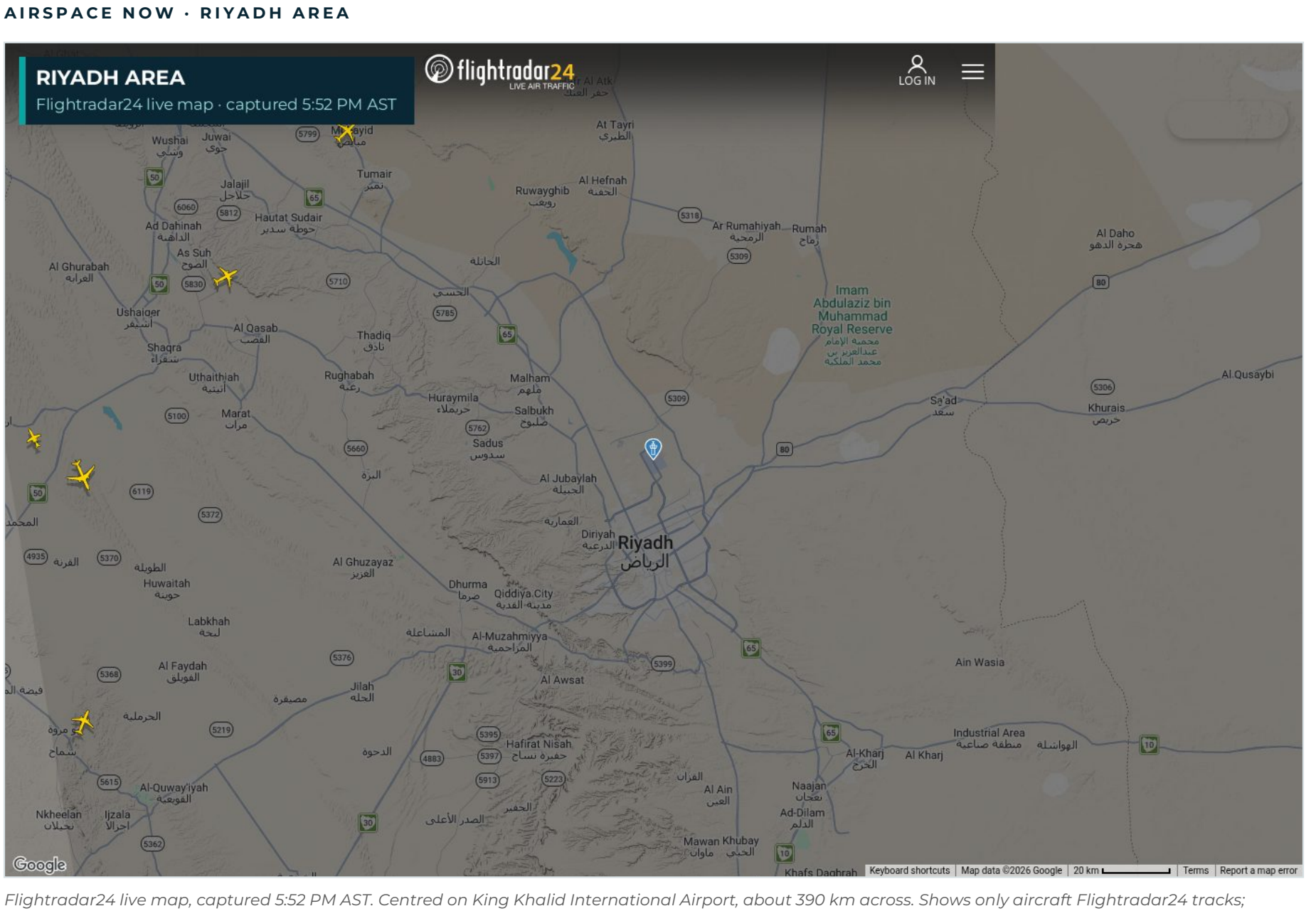
Recorded takeoffs (1) and landings (1) at RUH per hour from 6:00 PM Thursday to 5:51 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are the permitted N437GA takeoff at 8:35 AM and Saudia SV979 landing at 10:26 AM Friday. Dammam's halts in the window ran 7:11–8:18 PM Thursday, 4:05–5:48 AM and 8:21–9:30 AM Friday, and one has been open since 4:41 PM Friday.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 8:35–10:26 AM	111 min
Halt 1:52 PM–8:35 AM	1123 min
OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	17062 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:52 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5 Dammam airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 4:41 PM (70 min).

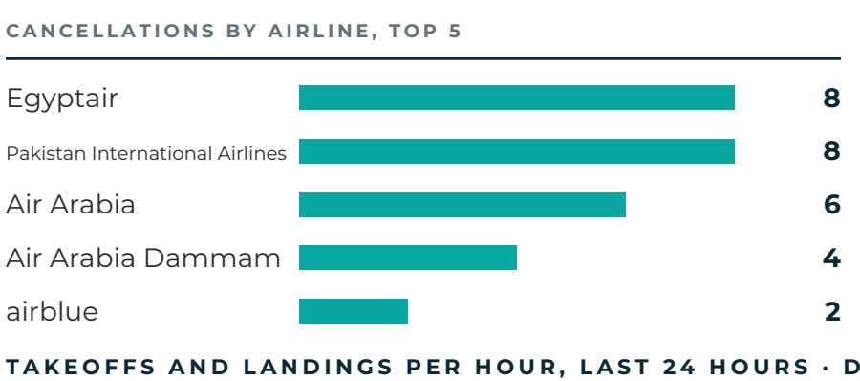
38	4:32 PM	4:41 PM	0	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
18 departures + 20 arrivals, 21% of 185 scheduled.	SV1115 to Jeddah, 80 min before 5:51 PM.	SV1118 from Jeddah, 70 min before 5:51 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:51 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 38 at 5:52 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

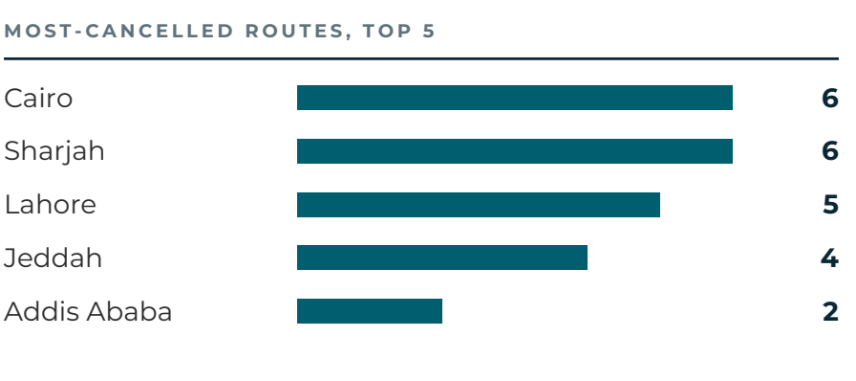
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	18	20	38	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	18 (19%)	20 (22%)	38	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	29 (30%)	13 (14%)	42	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	13 (31%)	28 (68%)	41	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	14 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	41 of 66	37 of 67	78 of 133	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	3	1	4	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	32	30	62	FR24 stats panel

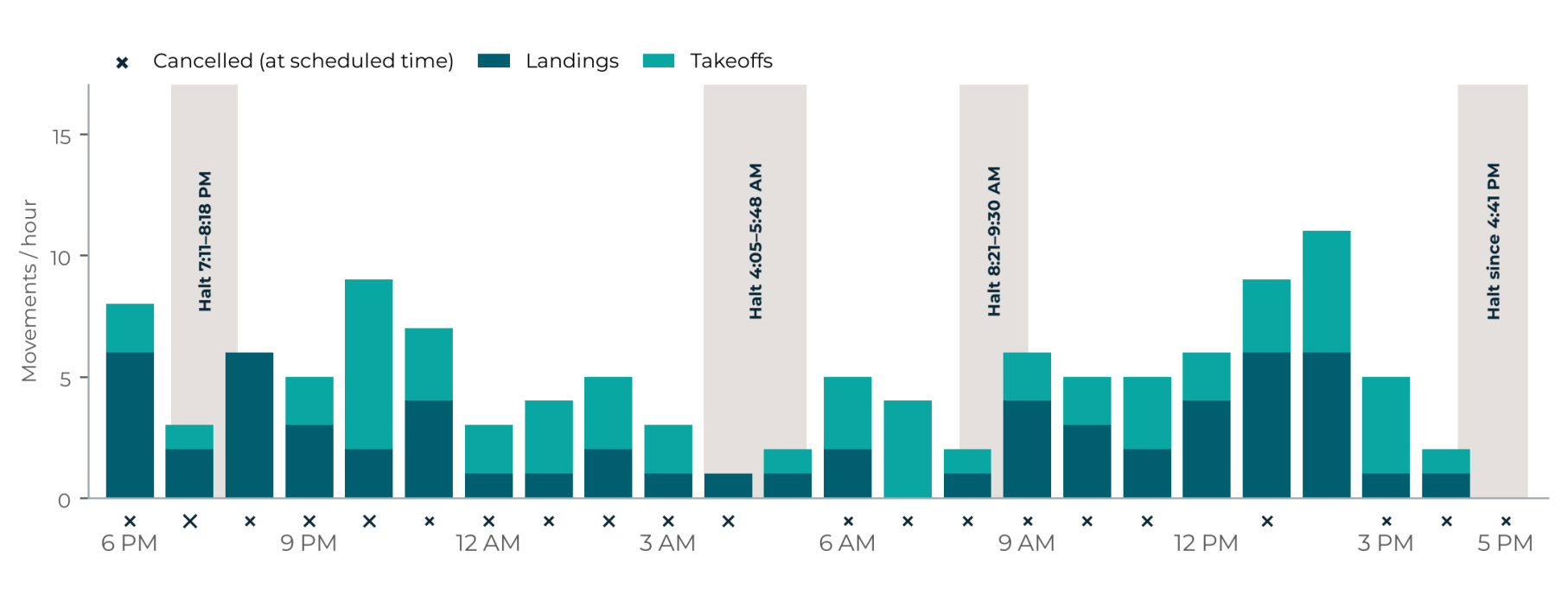
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (56) and landings (60) at DMM per hour from 6:00 PM Thursday to 5:51 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Halted since 4:41 PM (79 min at 6:00 PM); earlier halt 8:21–9:30 AM (69 min)

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 4:41 PM	70 min and counting
Halt 8:21–9:30 AM	69 min
Halt 4:05–5:48 AM	103 min
Halt 7:11–8:18 PM	66 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

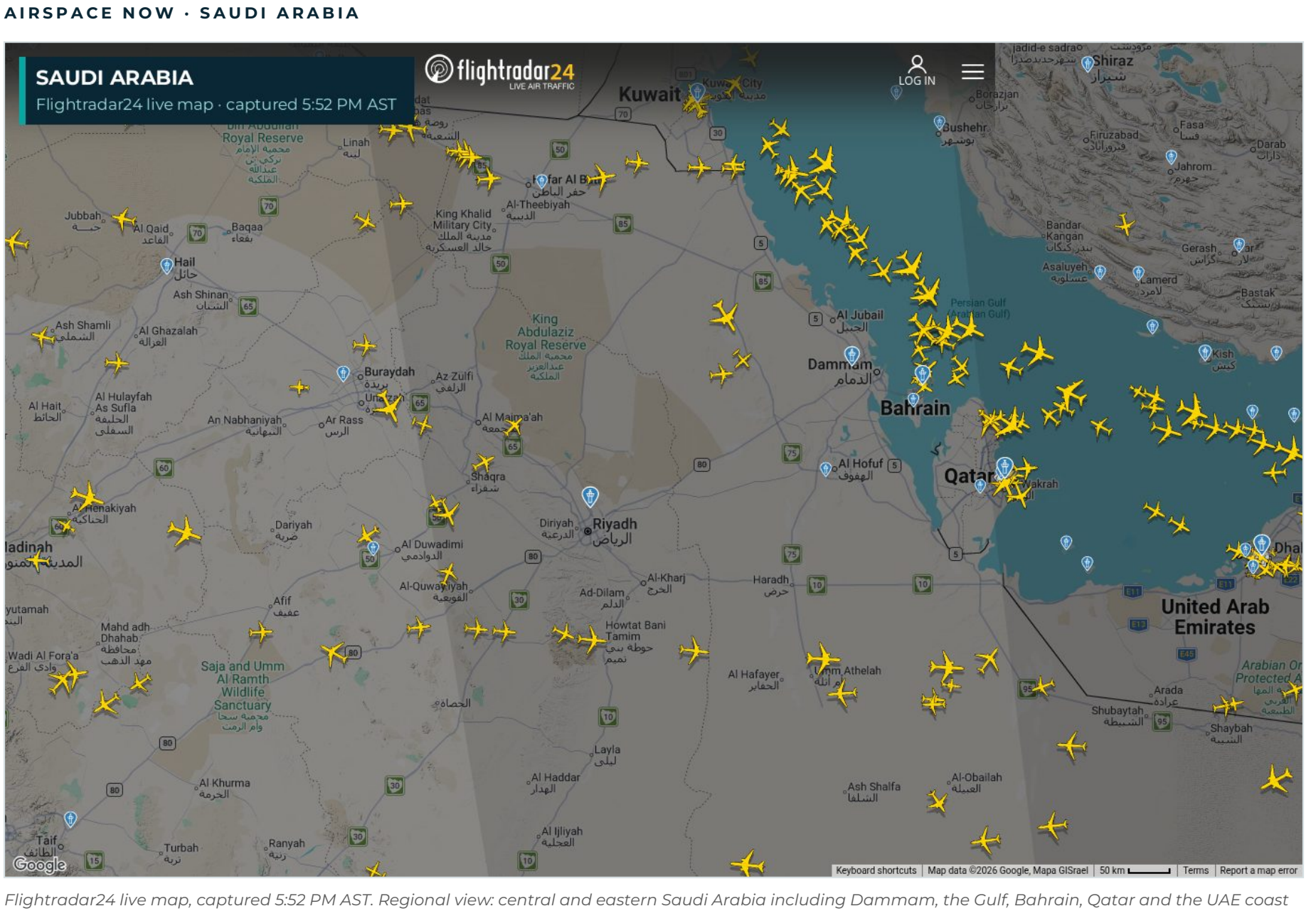
CONFIRMED **Eastern Province health: Saudi German Hospital treated one of the injured from the Dammam airport attack** (Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · 4:07 PM)

CONFIRMED **Arab League condemns the Houthi attacks on Dammam's King Fahd airport and the Shaybah oilfield** (SPA (@Spa_Eng) and Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · 1:26 PM)

CONFIRMED **Father of Sultan Al-Qahtani, killed in the Dammam airport attack, says his son ran to put out the fire near the aircraft** (Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · 9:33 PM)

CONFIRMED **Kuwait condemns the Houthi attack on Dammam's King Fahd airport** (SPA (@SPAregions) · 8:42 PM)

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



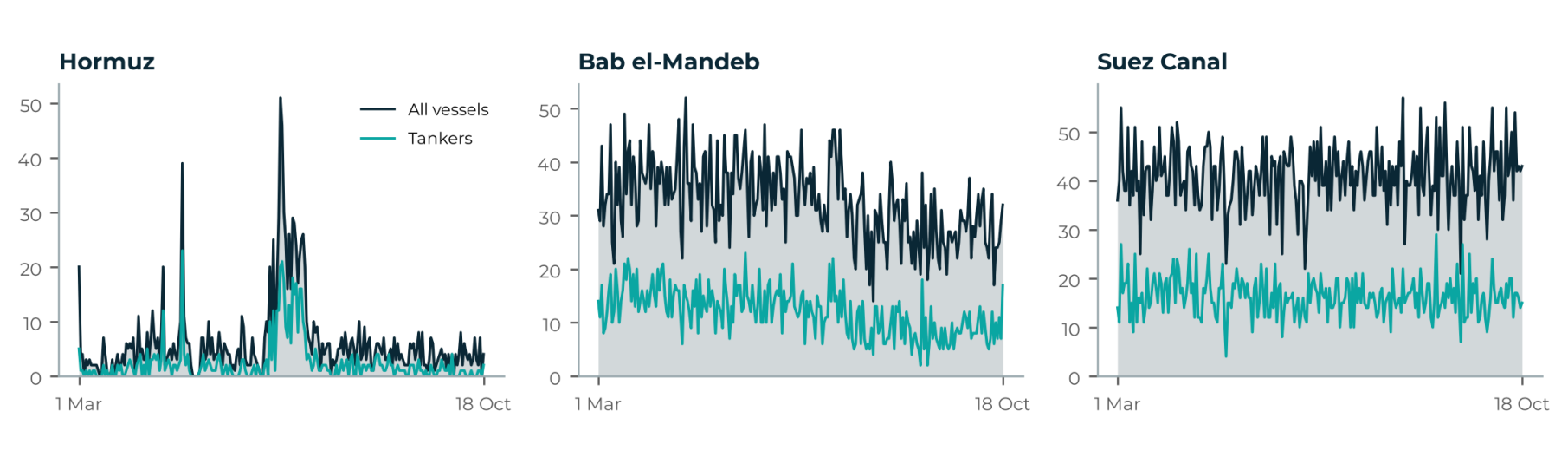
Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:52 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

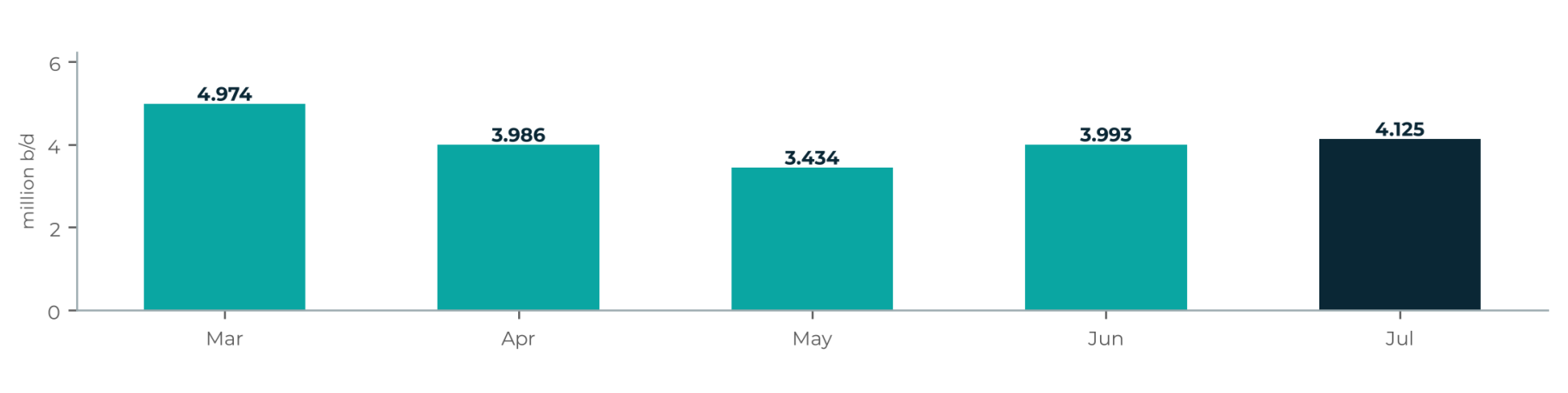
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 18 Oct	**4**	2	2	3.7 (4.1)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 18 Oct	**32**	17	15	26.4 (28.3)
Suez Canal	Sun 18 Oct	**43**	15	28	44.3 (41.7)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 5:52 PM, Fri 23 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

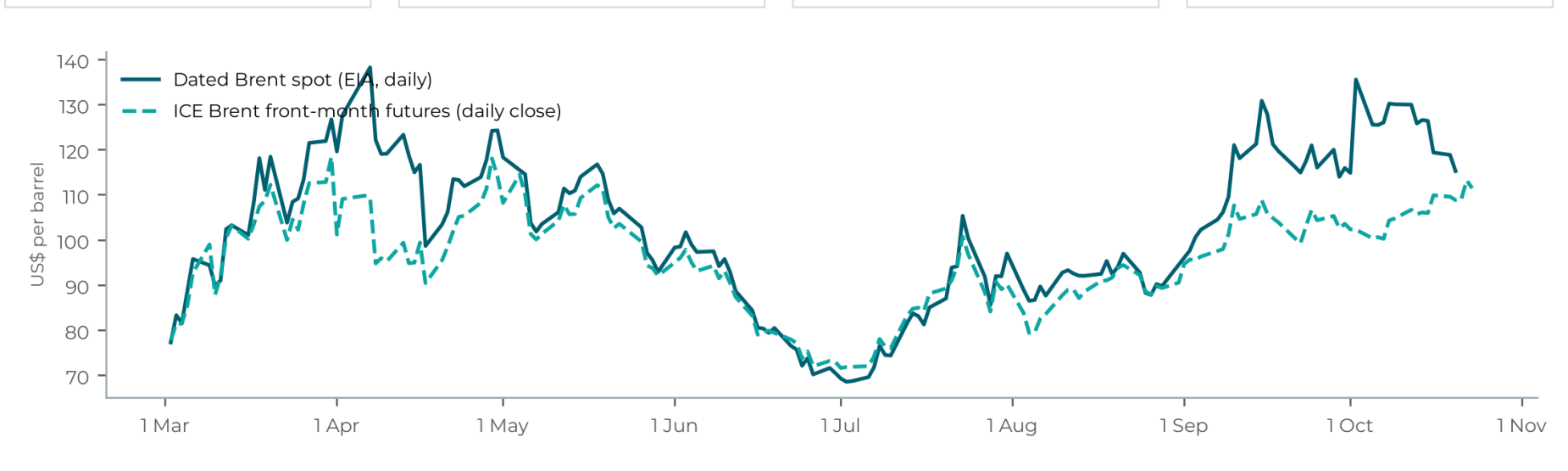


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$111.42	$115.22	-4%	+49%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 5:42 PM, Fri 23 Oct AST (+2.5% on day). Near real time.	Tue 20 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $119.66 on Fri 18 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 5:51 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
5:51 PM, Fri 23 Oct	5:51 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	RUH Halted · DMM Halted	Open sources · not official	9:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 9:00 PM